



Portability lives in the artefacts you own

✓ **Abstract: thin, firm-owned**
where switching is likely and the interface is small

✗ **Do not over-abstract**
wrappers drift behind every upstream release

- L5** **Memory API**
write · recall · forget by subject · snapshot
- L6** **Retrieval interface**
one thin call returning IDs and scores
- L7** **Embed and rerank service**
model version on every vector
- L9** **Telemetry collector**
firm-owned, open, with redaction
- L9** **Evaluation datasets**
datasets and scorers in source control
- C1** **Routing contract**
one API contract at the gateway; no provider SDKs
- C3** **Privacy API**
detect · transform · re-identify
- C4** **Policy as code**
open policy language, with tests
- C5** **Configuration fetch**
one call, with a file-based fallback
- C7** **Credentials**
workload identity and a vault; no standing secrets

- L1** **Vendor model extras**
only behind an adapter with a feature-free fallback
- L3** **Agent frameworks**
no firm-wide wrapper: frameworks on top of frameworks. Keep specification, prompts, tools and evaluations outside, and a rewrite is bounded work
- L3** **Single-workflow plug-ins**
one workflow with one model step needs no plug-in architecture
- L6** **Plain database access**
no layer between every query and the database
- L6·L7** **Store-bundled features**
use only if the model is pinned and raw text is kept outside; never abstract to hide an unpinned model

THE SIGNAL
Framework currency
days behind the pinned framework's latest security fix, held inside the patch window (for example, 30 days)

MULTI-VENDOR IS NECESSARY

two unrelated model vendorsan open-weight exit route

two red-team tools, one independent

two gateway deployments

two guardrail detectors

MULTI-VENDOR ONLY ADDS COMPLEXITY

two orchestration frameworks

a second cloud's agent stack

two vector stores, one corpus

two observability platforms

two identity providers for agents